

May 15 incident, 1932

15 May 1932 -> group of naval officers -> from League of Blood and other activists -> assassinated PM Inukai Tsuyoshi.

- Inukai had angered some of the extremists by opposing the actions of the military in Manchuria.
- he refused to give official govt acceptance of the state of Manchukuo when it was announced in February 1932.

the day they killed Inukai -> attackers also attacked the Mitsubishi Bank, the Seiyukai Headquarters, and several power stations - and tried to assassinate several other government officials as well.

- it was an attempted coup d'état
 - they had hoped that the people would rise up to support them and overthrow Japan's democratic govt.
 - people did not rise up.
 - League of Blood activists were arrested and put on trial.
 - however, military commanders did not condemn the rebellion and even issued a statement - which effectively excused the officers for their actions and demanded political reform in Japan.
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although military did not spell it out precisely -> they wanted control of govt.

- after talks with military leaders, Seiyukai party was prevented from forming a new cabinet even though it had the majority share of representatives in the diet.
 - 26 May 1932 -> emperor appointed a navy admiral as Japan's new PM.
 - his cabinet had 15 members - of whom just 5 were elected civilian party representatives.
 - remaining 10 were military officers and govt officials.
 - with majority of the cabinet made up of military officers, Japan now came under militarist rule.
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